

Kaan Koc

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Education

University of California, Santa Cruz

Expected Graduation: June 2026

Bachelor of Science, Computer Science

GPA: 3.85

Relevant Coursework: Distributed Systems, Operating Systems, Data Structures, Algorithms, Web Applications

Experience

Software Engineering Intern (Backend)

Sept. 2024 – Present

Tech4Good Lab | Python, FastAPI, Node.js, PostgreSQL, LangChain, Docker

Santa Cruz, CA

- Delivered scalable backend systems supporting **AI content** platforms in production.
- Improved search relevance with a LangChain RAG pipeline on **FastAPI + PostgreSQL**, cutting latency by **~30%** through async I/O and caching.
- Integrated **LLM microservices** into a **Node.js backend**, raising success rates **from 78% to 93%**.
- Built unit and integration tests** with **pytest/Jest**, increasing coverage by **~45%** and reducing production bugs, which cut incident reports by **~30%**.

Software Engineering Project Lead (Full-Stack)

Sept. 2024 – June 2025

Slug AI (Largest AI Club at UCSC) | Django, Express.js, React, MySQL, MongoDB, AWS

Santa Cruz, CA

- Recruited and led 12+ developers**, training freshmen into active contributors; **6+ later secured SWE internships** after project experience.
- Directed **4 full-stack projects for local businesses**, delivering dashboards and AI analytics that cut manual workflows by **~30%**.
- Architected **Django/Express.js** backends with **MySQL and MongoDB**, and **React/Next.js frontends**, deployed into production environments actively used by business staff.
- Drove agile sprints, code reviews, and testing, raising project delivery speed by **~40%** over previous semesters.

Software Engineering Intern (Backend)

June 2023 – Sept. 2023

Papatia | C#, Java, Node.js, PostgreSQL, AWS, Docker

Remote

- Contributed to backend systems** for e-commerce platforms serving **European clients**, powering customer transactions and product catalogs.
- Applied **object-oriented programming (OOP)** in **C# and Java** to build modular payment and order services.
- Collaborated through **GitHub pull requests**, merging 20+ successfully reviewed contributions into production.
- Improved **API response times by ~25%** and deployed with **Docker on AWS**, ensuring **99.9% uptime**.

Awards & Certifications

Global Finalist – NASA Space Apps Challenge 2024, selected from 10,000+ international participants

Sept. 2024

Projects

SailMate AI | HTML/CSS, JavaScript, FastAPI, OpenAI API, Vercel, Render, PostgreSQL

May 2025 – Aug. 2025

- Integrated **AI-generated sailing safety reports** into the FastAPI backend, adding caching, retries, and structured parsing to cut latency by **~40%** and reduce API costs by **~25%**.
- Designed a responsive HTML/JS frontend with map visualizations and alerts, reducing trip-planning time by **~40%**, and validated adoption via feedback **from 30+ user surveys..**

Shipwright AI | React, TypeScript, FastAPI, Node.js, MongoDB, GitLab CI/CD

Mar. 2024 – June 2024

- Built an **automation platform** that converts natural language prompts into production-ready software, reducing project setup time by **~80%**.
- Automated GitLab repo creation, pipeline configs, and Dockerized deployments**, cutting time-to-deployment from **hours to minutes**.

Technical Skills

Programming Languages: C/C++, Python, Java, C#, Kotlin, TypeScript, JavaScript, SQL, HTML/CSS, Assembly

Frameworks: FastAPI, Node.js, Express.js, Django, Next.js, React, React Native, Flask, Tailwind

Tools: REST APIs, Pytest, Jest, LangChain, Scikit-learn, Pandas, NumPy, Docker, Git, Figma, Linux

Databases/Cloud: MySQL, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, AWS, Google Cloud Platform